Storyboard: public EV charging in France, where it lags and how fast the gap is closing

Oscar Masdupuy, EFREI Paris, BIA. Data Visualization 2026. Figures from the data of 19 October 2026. *Formatting with the help of AI.*

Audience Département and regional planners who write or revise a local charging master plan (SDIRVE, created by the 2019 LOM law).

Questions Where is public charging thin once population and EV ownership are taken into account? Is the gap between départements closing?

Hypothesis tested Deployment sped up after 2021 but stayed in large metropolitan areas and on motorways, leaving rural départements behind on fast charging.

Takeaway The first half holds, the second does not. Rural mainland départements are level with dense ones, and the gap is closing. The gaps that remain are overseas and, per car, in dense départements around Paris.

1. Hook
Why it matters
149,328 public points, but Guyane lists 1 for 293,996 people.

2. Context
Where my area stands
KPIs and timeline: 1,895 dated points in 2020, 8,897 in 2021, 18,256 in 2023.

3. Insights
Where the gaps are
Rural is not behind; the gap ratio fell from 5.8 to 2.2; overseas stalls.

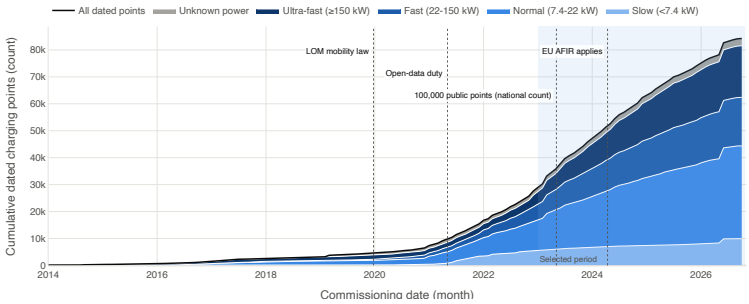
4. Implications
What to do next
Check overseas data first; on the mainland, look at fast charging in dense areas and at EPCI level.

#	App section	Planner's question	Visual	Headline insight (computed)	Interaction
1	Introduction	Why should I look at this?	Title and headline sentence	France lists 149,328 points, 219 per 100,000 people; the rechargeable fleet grew 6.6-fold since December 2020.	None: national figures
2	1. Overview: KPI header	Where does my area stand?	Five KPI tiles with deltas vs France	France: 219 points per 100k, 5.4 per 100 cars, 37% fast, +205% since 2023.	Every sidebar filter
3	1. Overview: deployment over time	How fast did deployment go?	Stacked cumulative area by power class, four policy dates, period shaded	1,895 dated points in 2020, 8,897 in 2021, peak of 18,256 in 2023.	Period, area, power, operator
4	2. Where the gaps are	Which départements are thin?	Choropleth (overseas as insets) and top/bottom 10 bars with France line	Hautes-Alpes leads with 452 per 100k; 52 of 100 départements sit below France.	Indicator selector (7 measures), hover
5	Rural or urban	Are rural areas behind?	Small multiples: one panel per power class, three density bands	Ultra-fast: 36 points per 100k in rural départements, 27 in dense ones.	Area filter
6	Charging vs EV ownership	Is charging keeping up with cars?	Scatter sized by population, AFIR band	5 départements below 0.8 kW per car; Hauts-de-Seine has 2.5 points per 100 cars.	Hover, data table
7	Is the gap closing?	Are laggards catching up?	Dumbbell by quarter of départements, years-to-reach table	Best vs least equipped quarter: 5.8 times in 2022, 2.2 times in October 2026.	Period start sets the baseline
8	Station map	Where exactly are the points?	Point map, 12,000 sampled points	44% of ultra-fast points sit in dedicated fast-charging stations.	Zoom, pan, power class
9	3. Data quality	Can I trust these numbers?	Cleaning table, checks, missingness bars	7,919 duplicates removed; 44% of points have no commissioning date.	None
10	4. Conclusions	What should I do?	Text: insights, implications, next steps	Overseas: 34 points per 100k vs 225 on the mainland.	None: national figures

Frames

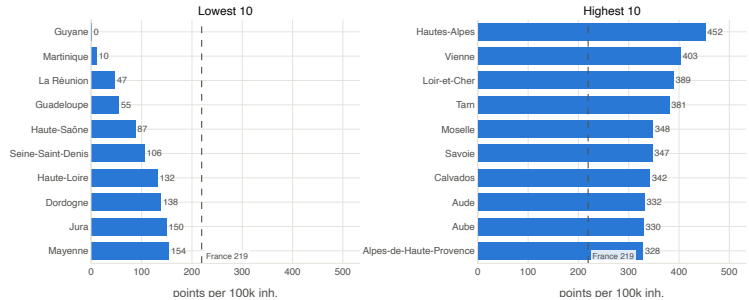
The charts as they appear in the app with the default filters (all France, period 2023 to 2026).

3. Deployment over time



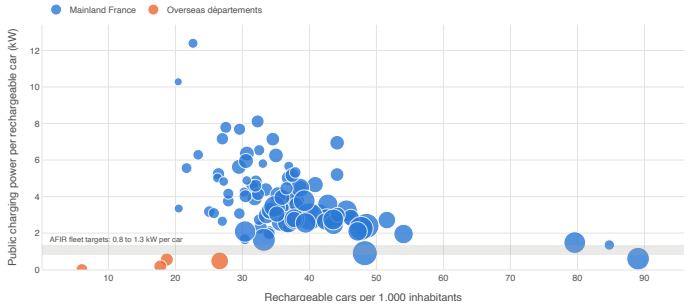
Cumulative dated points by power class. Dotted lines: LOM law, open-data duty, 100,000-point milestone, EU AFIR.

4. Ranking



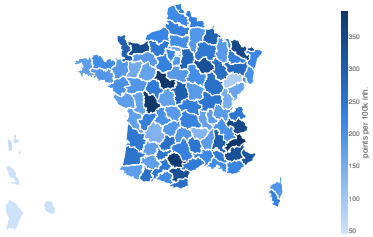
Lowest and highest 10 départements, dashed line at the France value (219).

6. Charging vs EV ownership



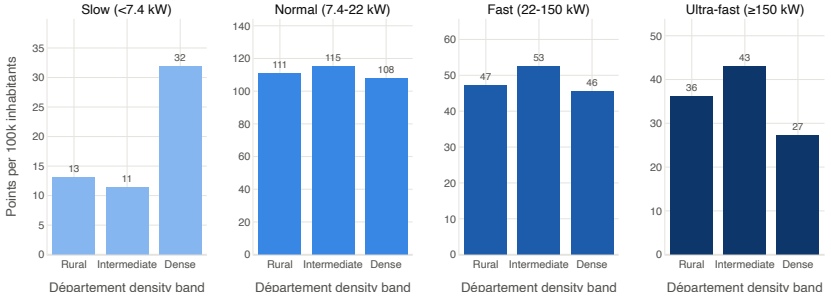
kW of public power per rechargeable car against cars per 1,000 inhabitants. Grey band: AFIR references.

4. Where the gaps are



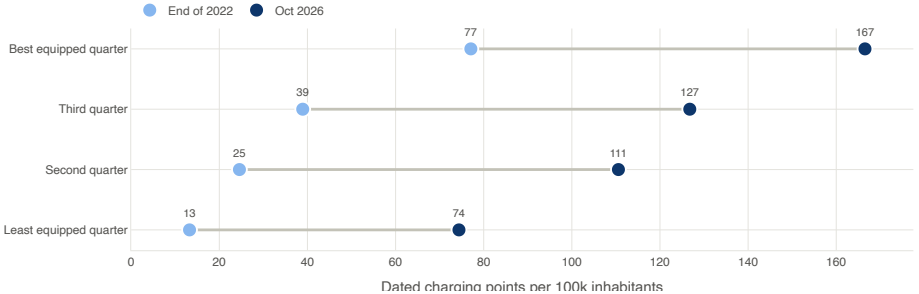
Points per 100,000 inhabitants. Darker means more. Overseas départements drawn as insets.

5. Rural or urban



Points per 100,000 inhabitants by density band, one panel per power class.

7. Is the gap closing?



Dated points per 100,000 inhabitants, end of 2022 (light) and October 2026 (dark), by quarter of départements.